Koustuv Saha

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Education

2021–2025 **Ph.D. Agricultural Economics**, Purdue University, Indiana, USA
Dissertation: *Essays on Women's Work and Agency in Agriculture*
Advisors: Dr. Kajal Gulati, Dr. Jacob Ricker-Gilbert

2017–2019 **M.Phil. Development Studies**, Indira Gandhi Institute of Development Research, Mumbai, India

2014–2016 **M.Sc. Economics**, University of Calcutta, India

2011–2014 **B.Sc. Economics**, University of Calcutta, India

Work Experience

Assistant Professor, Azim Premji University, Ranchi 2026–

Postdoctoral Researcher, American University of Sharjah 2025–2026

Graduate Research Assistant, Purdue University 2021–2025

Research Associate, Indira Gandhi Institute of Development Research 2017–2020

Awards

Uma Lele Prize for Best Contributed Paper on Gender, International Conference of Agricultural Economists, 2024. *For paper titled "Women's Work and Agricultural Productivity Gaps in India".*

Ludwig Kruhe Fellowship, Purdue University (USD 68,766), 2024. *Awarded to the most outstanding graduate students across seven departments.*

UGC Junior Research Fellowship, Government of India, 2017. *Awarded to top 6% of candidates nationally.*

Publications

Gulati, K., **Saha, K.**, & Lybbert, T.J. (2025). "Women's Work and Agricultural Productivity Gaps in India." *American Journal of Agricultural Economics.* doi.org/10.1111/ajae.12536 *Awarded Uma Lele Prize for Best Paper.*

Saha, K., Pandey, V.L., & Dev, S.M. (2023). "Women's Land Ownership and Household Decisions: Implications for Child Health in Rural India." In *Axes of Sustainable Development and Growth in India.* Springer Nature. doi.org/10.1007/978-981-19-9756-3_8

Job Market Paper

Strategy and Coordination in Risky Household Decisions (*Selected for presentation at AAEA Annual Conference 2026*)

Abstract: How well do spouses coordinate risk-taking decisions in the household? This paper uses a lab-in-the-field experiment with married couples in Bangladesh to show that most people hold mistaken beliefs about their spouse's risk-taking behavior. In a sequential lottery-choice game, husbands and wives each selected a lottery while sharing the combined winnings from both. Under imperfect information about their spouse's choice, only one in four subjects successfully coordinates with their spouse so as to achieve their intended household risk-exposure level. While women try to incorporate their spouse's risk preference in their own lottery choice, men ignore their partner's preferences. As a result, women are more likely than men to be mistaken about the level of risk the household is exposed to. I validate these findings, showing that mistaken beliefs about a spouse's risk-taking predict actual mistaken beliefs about the spouse's savings and assets. These findings suggest that targeting policy initiatives such as microcredit to women rather than their partners can ensure a more equitable

use of funds and reduce information asymmetry between partners about household risk exposure.

Working Papers

Saha, K., Gulati, K., & Bird, S. "Agricultural Mechanization and Gendered Structural Transformation in India." (*Presented at PacDev, March 2026.*)

Saha, K., Yadav, S., & **Saha, K.** "Gender Role Attitudes and Female Labor Participation: Evidence from Egypt." (*Presented at All UC Labor Conference, April 2025.*)

Atallah, S., Lopes, A.A., **Saha, K.**, & Dissanayake, S. "Coexistence, Conflict, And Wildlife Spiritual Values Among Indigenous Herders." (*Under review at the Journal of Environmental Economics and Management.*)

Saha, K., Lopes, A.A., & Tasneem, D. "Prickly Neighbors: Religion, Risk, and Human–Wildlife Coexistence." (*Fieldwork scheduled for May 2026*)

Works In Progress

"Cross-country Analysis of Diet Affordability and Nutrition Outcomes." (With Soumya Gupta, Adrian Lopes & Adaleeb Rahman)

"Data-driven Approach to Selecting Structurally Similar Donor Pool for SCM." (With Pattawee Puangchit)

"Biocertification for fisheries in the East Kolkata Wetlands." (With Avishek Rakshit)

"Soil Moisture Thresholds and Agricultural Productivity Gaps in India." (With Soumik Paul)

Grants

Rolling Research Grant, American University of Sharjah (USD 16,338), 2025-26. Role: Co-principal Investigator.

Jim and Neta Hicks Graduate Student Grant, Purdue University (USD 7,500), 2023.

AAEA Travel Grant 2024 and 2025.

Purdue Graduate Student Government (PGSG) Travel Grant, 2024.

Conference Presentations

Agricultural & Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting. New Orleans, LA — July 2024
"Agricultural mechanization and gendered structural transformation in India."

Pacific Conference for Development Economics. Stanford University, Stanford, CA — March 2024
"Women's Work and Agricultural Productivity Gaps in India"

Refereeing Experience

Agricultural Economics, *Environment and Development Economics*, *International Social Science Journal*, *Review of Development Economics*

Teaching

Instructor	ECO 500: Indian Economy and Society (Graduate)	*Ongoing*
	ECO 201: Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate)	2025
	AGEC 217: Introductory Economics (Undergraduate)	2024
Teaching Assistant	Econometrics I (Graduate)	2018

Technical & Language Skills

Analytical	STATA (Expert), R (Advanced), GAMS (Intermediate), Python (Intermediate), QGIS (Intermediate), Julia (Intermediate)
Survey	SurveyCTO, Survey Solutions
Field Experience	Bangladesh, India
Language	English (Professional fluency), Bengali (Native), Hindi (Conversational)

References

Dr. Kajal Gulati	Assistant Professor, AFRE, Michigan State University gulatik4@msu.edu
Dr. Adrian Lopes	Associate Professor, Economics, American University of Sharjah alopes@aus.edu
Dr. Shadi Atallah	Associate Professor, Agricultural & Consumer Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign satallah@illinois.edu
Dr. Jacob Ricker-Gilbert	Professor, Agricultural Economics, Purdue University jrickerg@purdue.edu
Dr. Colin D. Sullivan	Assistant Professor, Economics, University of Pittsburgh colindsullivan@pitt.edu